# EJ FOX



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## PROFILE

Design engineer and creative technologist. I do my best work under deadline pressure. I turn complicated information into interactive graphics people can actually read, and I have fun doing it. The work mixes journalistic curiosity with an addiction to trying new things. That has included NBC's election-night graphics and experimental interfaces for embeddings. I want to make things no one has seen before, with smart, kind people.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Code:** JavaScript, Python, Node.js, Vue, React, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, SQL

**Graphics:** D3, Observable Plot, Three.js, WebGL, Canvas, SVG, TopoJSON

**AI/ML:** LLM APIs, embedding visualization, context management, vector databases, prompt engineering, tool usage, alternative interfaces

**Design & Motion:** Illustrator, Photoshop, Final Cut Pro, After Effects, Principle, Figma, Animation (GSAP, Anime.js)

**Methods:** Rapid prototyping, joy-driven development, component systems, public documentation, performance optimization, video demos

## EXPERIENCE

### Lenfest AI Fellow

*Arizona State University NEWSWELL | 2025 - 2026*

The Lenfest Institute's AI Collaborative and Fellowship Program, hosted at ASU and supported by OpenAI and Microsoft

- I built a tool that uses AI to lay out the ads and stories in small local print newspapers
- I gave an Ignite talk about it at ASU's National Journalism + AI Accelerator in January 2026
- On demo day I showed it to OpenAI, Microsoft, ProPublica and the Boston Globe

### Design Engineer & Creative Technologist

*Independent Consultant | 2019 - Present*

Select Clients: GitHub • NBC News • CBS News • Washington Post • New York Times • Carnegie Mellon • Stamen

- I take the tight-deadline projects that need short sprints and real user testing, especially things no one has built before
- I helped CBS News prototype its broadcast touchscreen app, analyzed newspaper front pages for the New York Times, and made geographic visualizations with the geniuses at Stamen.
- I work between design and engineering, in whatever stack the client already has, from brand-new startups to big companies with their own process
- I work in public when I can. There are 50+ Observable notebooks, plus livestreams on YouTube and blog posts about what I'm making and how.

### Founder

*Room 302 Studio | 2023 - Present*

Select Clients: The Associated Press • Wildlife Conservation Society • Earth Genome

- My prototyping shop for new kinds of data visualization and analysis, usually on tight deadlines
- I built the studio's manager on top of an LLM. It's our 'AI team member'
- We turn rough ideas into demos good enough for a client to show their bosses or take to a funder

- I worked with the Associated Press team on its 2024 election coverage, which was nominated for a Webby.
- I helped the Wildlife Conservation Society map coral reefs that are holding up against climate change and tell their story

### Contractor

*Stamen Design | 2020 - 2022*

- I made geographic visualizations with the Stamen team

### Senior Interactive Graphics Specialist

*NBC News | 2016 - 2019*

- I was lead designer on the 2018 relaunch of the election-night Big Board and built it with Michael Small and the NBC News Digital teams. The New York Times called it "newly juiced-up." It's still in use today.

### Graphics Editor

*Vocativ | 2014 - 2016*

- I automated enough of the desk to go from five graphics a month to five a day
- I led the winning Knight Foundation grant pitch for Dataproofer, a tool that checks datasets for errors
- I gave reporters a visualization platform they could use on their own, made the templates, and ran daily breaking-news graphics

### Early Career

- *GitHub (2013)*: I worked with the GitHub team on the "State of the Octoverse" site and its visualizations
- *Visual.ly (2011)*: I was on the core team that built one of the first visualization-as-a-service platforms

## PROJECTS

**Subway Builder** · Borough Studio, 2025 - 2026. Colin Miller's subway-building game. He was in Room 302 Studio and brought me on as his first developer. One of the lead developers. I built the desktop version for the July 2026 Steam launch.

**Decision Desk HQ**, 2025 - 2026. I work on design and engineering for the tools broadcasters use to show election results

**Global Energy Ownership Tracker** · Global Energy Monitor, 2025 - 2026. An explorer of who owns the world's energy assets, with ownership trees, embeddable cards and a screener

**Paramilitary Leaks**, 2025. I built an explorer and visualizations for 200 GB of leaked militia chats. Micah Lee cited it in his reporting.

**NYPD misconduct network** · WNYC/Gothamist, 2021. I did the network analysis of civilian complaint records for an investigation into clusters of officers accused of misconduct again and again

**Climate TRACE** · Earthrise Media, 2022. I made maps and data exploration tools for emissions sources around the world

**Ukraine grain** · Earth Genome, 2022 - 2023. A scrolling data story about global food security

**COVIDcast** · Carnegie Mellon University Delphi, 2020. I prototyped visualizations for the public COVID-19 indicators, July to September 2020

**Election simulator** · Washington Post Opinions, 2019 - 2020. I did engineering on an interactive simulator built on David Byler's election model

**Dark-money map** · Mother Jones, 2012. I co-authored an interactive map of the super PAC and dark-money universe